

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1065

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Freed-Hardeman University women's basketball team upon winning the 2026 Mid-South Conference Championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, the Freed-Hardeman University Lady Lions have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning the Mid-South Conference Championship and advancing to the Round of 16 in the 2026 NAIA National Tournament; and

WHEREAS, Freed-Hardeman was perfect in non-conference play and then posted a 9-3 record in the Mid-South Conference to finish the regular season as co-champions; and

WHEREAS, in the Mid-South Conference Tournament, the Lady Lions vanquished Cumberland in the quarterfinals, defeated (RV) Cumberlands in the semifinal round, and bested Bethel (Tennessee) in the championship game to claim the conference's automatic bid to the NAIA National Tournament; and

WHEREAS, playing host for the first two rounds of the Big Dance, Freed-Hardeman blasted Rust and then topped Bethel (Indiana) to advance to the Round of 16 in Sioux City, Iowa; and

WHEREAS, the following players are proud to roar like Lady Lions: JB Clifton, Brooklyn Crouch, Julie Hampton, Rachel Satterly (Second Team All-Mid-South Conference honoree), Carissa Curtis, Jenna Satterly (First Team All-American and First Team All-Mid-South Conference honoree), Jocy May, Julieth Rivera Morales, Ally Weathers (two-time Mid-South

Conference Player of the Week), Lilly Kee (First Team All-American and First Team All-Mid-South Conference honoree), Elli Chumley, and Alaina Stiles; and

WHEREAS, the Lady Lions' superb performance would not have been possible without the expert guidance of Head Coach Abby Stutts, her assistant coach, Darby Phillips, and student assistants, Angelina Barr and Aubrey Merritt; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Freed-Hardeman University women's basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes; they have not only achieved a premier level of success in competition but have also distinguished themselves as scholars, with twelve players earning Academic All-Mid-South Conference honors; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young women not only made possible a championship season but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Freed-Hardeman Lady Lions for their outstanding season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the players and coaches of the Freed-Hardeman University Lady Lions women's basketball team upon winning the Mid-South Conference Championship and advancing to the Round of 16 in the 2026 NAIA National Tournament and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.